

CISA and DHS are initiating greater cybersecurity in the US

The Cybersecurity and Infrastructure Security Agency (CISA) in the US plans to step up efforts to increase transparency and visibility in the software and technology supply chains, with a variety of initiatives building towards what the agency's executive director refers to as "cyber safety."



For example, CISA and the Science and Technology Directorate of the US Department of Homeland Security (DHS) are planning studies to examine the usage of open source software in key infrastructure sectors. At a GitHub-sponsored event in January this year at the Center for Strategic and International Studies, senior advisor and strategist Allan Friedman, CISA, made a statement. While the majority of open source operations take place outside of agency boundaries, according to Friedman, the government can step in when "huge resources aren't accessible today," such as when it comes to essential infrastructure.

One aspect of the Biden administration's focus on cybersecurity is open source software. In a panel discussion at this year's Consumer Electronics Show in Las Vegas, Nevada, CISA director Jen Easterly raised a concern about "decades of insecure technological design." The Software Bill of Materials concept is being promoted by Friedman and his colleagues at CISA, and the White House plans to introduce a national cybersecurity labelling programme for some Internet-connected products this spring.

By making the project open source, it will be possible for some of its components to continue to exist, even if only as a tool for other developers to understand how it was created.

Since the game is distributed under a Creative Commons Zero license, both private and commercial use of all the components is permitted. You might use the Duelyst sprite art into your own game or create something altogether new on top of the current codebase.

Duelyst II, the successor of Duelyst, is now available on Steam. It has been released by Dream Sloth Games, after taking permission from Counterplay Games to create it.

Tech leaders call for safeguarding consumer privacy in the blockchain industry

In an open letter released recently, digital rights advocacy group Fight for the Future has asked the US Congress to "take a bold position" to safeguard consumer privacy while regulating the blockchain industry. The letter has been signed by dozens of companies and organisations, including industry players such as the Blockchain Association, DeFi Education Fund, Ledger, Nillion Network, Protocol Labs and Proton.

The letter also criticised attempts by members of Congress to deanonymize blockchain transactions, such as legislation put forth late last year by Senators Elizabeth Warren and Roger Marshall, which would require blockchain intermediaries to register as financial institutions and follow the rules set forth by



the Bank Secrecy Act for gathering information about customers. It urged Congress to adopt laws that will support privacy-preserving technologies.

These safeguards must include encrypted chat apps, which the group claims

are vulnerable to assault. Privacy groups continue to be concerned about the protracted disputes over encryption between American law enforcement agencies domestically and abroad. The FBI deemed Apple's decision to completely encrypt its cloud services "very troubling" in December.

Rapid Silicon receives US\$ 30 million in funding

Rapid Silicon, a maker of open source-based FPGAs with a focus on the intelligent edge and AI, has announced the completion of a US\$ 30 million series A round of funding. The business has closed US\$ 15 million in capital from Cambium Capital and other sources, including all the original seed round investors. The second closing is scheduled for Q1 2023.

The funding will be used to expand Rapid Silicon's product line; support the release of Gemini, its flagship low-end FPGA device; and continue the company's trend of promoting the use of open source software in commercial applications.

Gemini is a power-optimised programmable logic device (PLD) designed for embedded and edge applications' high sensor processing demands, constrained thermal environments, and constricting physical dimensions. The company says its